

Sajad Ebrahimi

✉ sadjadeb@gmail.com | [sadjadeb.github.io](https://github.com/sadjadeb) | [sadjadeb](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sadjadeb) | [Google Scholar](#) | 🏠 Toronto, ON

Summary

- Graduate researcher in **NLP and Information Retrieval** with 10+ peer-reviewed publications (TIST, SIGIR, WSDM); focus on Generative Approaches for Ranking, Retrieval Augmented Generation, Machine Generated Content Detection, and Automated Scholarly Peer Review.
- Over 5 years of hands-on coding experience, spanning roles as a Data Scientist and a Software Engineer, specializing in designing, building, and deploying production-scale software and machine learning systems. Advanced proficiency in PyTorch, Django, Accelerate, Transformers, and related tools.

Education

Ph.D. in Information (Incoming), University of Toronto
Supervisor: Dr. Ebrahim Bagheri
Toronto, Canada | 2026 -

M.A.Sc. in Computer Engineering, University of Guelph
Supervisor: Dr. Fattane Zarrinkalam | Research Mentor: Dr. Bhaskar Mitra
Guelph, Canada | 2023 - 2025
Affiliated with [Vector Institute for Artificial Intelligence](#) as Faculty Affiliate Researcher

- **GPA:** 89/100
- **Thesis:** DiffusionRank: A Denoising Diffusion Framework for Learning to Rank

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering, Ferdowsi University of Mashhad
Mashhad, Iran | 2018 - 2023
• **GPA:** 81/100

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of Toronto
Supervisor: Dr. Ebrahim Bagheri
Fall 2025 - Fall 2026

- Working on Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) and Agentic Systems for Ranking.

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Guelph
Supervisors: Dr. Fattane Zarrinkalam, Dr. Ebrahim Bagheri, and Dr. Bhaskar Mitra
Fall 2023 - Summer 2025

- Worked on applying the concept of DDPMs to Learning-to-Rank.

Research Intern, Toronto Metropolitan University
Supervisor: Dr. Ebrahim Bagheri
Fall 2022 - Summer 2023

- Worked on Query Performance Prediction (QPP) and Enhancing retrievers by utilizing Entity Linking.

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Ferdowsi University of Mashhad
Supervisor: Dr. Behshid Behkamal
Summer 2021 - Summer 2022

- Engineered datasets and automated data pipelines using schemas and scrapers for global university catalogs.

Work Experience

Data Scientist, [Reviewerly](#)
Toronto, Canada | Nov 2023 -

- Built and now maintain a Milvus-backed index of 260M+ papers and 96M+ authors, delivering sub-second similarity search that powers Reviewerly's matching engine, adopted by two peer-review venues and one grant agency in its first release cycle.
- Parallelized a keyphrase extraction model across 6 GPUs to process 200M records, accelerating the process by 10x.

Data Analyst, Kava Investment Analysis

Tehran, Iran | Sept 2021 - Aug 2022

- Built a scalable web scraper that collected data from 4+ sources across the Tehran Stock Exchange, reducing manual data collection time by 90%.

Software Engineer Intern, Zima & Iliasystem Co.

Mashhad, Iran | Aug 2019 - Feb 2021

- Implemented REST APIs and DB schemas for 3 internal tools used by 10+ engineers; shipped 2 internal web UIs (HTML/CSS/JS).

Publications

IPM	Saliminabi MH, Ebrahimi S , Rad RH, Androutsos D, Zarrinkalam F, Bagheri E. Diffusion-based generative modeling for expert team formation . Information Processing & Management. 2026 Nov 1
SIGIR 2026	Sadeghian S, Daqiq A, Cheraghi R, Ebrahimi S , Arabzadeh N, Bagheri E. PeerPrism: Peer Evaluation Expertise vs Review-writing AI . In Proceedings of the 49th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval
SIGIR 2026	Arabzadeh N, Ebrahimi S , Daqiq A, Sadeghian S, Hosseini M, Le HS, Bashari M, Bagheri E. From Doxa to Logos in Scientific Peer Review. In Proceedings of the 49th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval
SIGIR 2026	Ghorbanpour A, Sadeghian S, Daqiq A, Ebrahimi S , Arabzadeh N, Hosseini M, Bagheri E. Peerispect: Claim Verification in Scientific Peer Reviews . In Proceedings of the 49th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval
ICTIR 2026	Ebrahimi S , Mitra B, Arabzadeh N, Yuan Y, Wu H, Zarrinkalam F, Bagheri E. From Noise to Order: Learning to Rank via Denoising Diffusion arxiv preprint arXiv:2602:11453
WWW 2026	Ebrahimi S , Sadeghian S, Ghorbanpour A, Arabzadeh N, Salamat S, Hosseini SM, Le HS, Bashari M, Bagheri E. PeeriScope: A Multi-Faceted Framework for Evaluating Peer Review Quality . In Proceedings of The 2026 ACM Web Conference
WSDM 2026	Arabzadeh N, Ebrahimi S , Sadeghian S, Hosseini M, Daqiq A, Le HS, Bashari M, Bagheri E. Can LLMs Uphold Research Integrity? Evaluating the Role of LLMs in Peer Review Quality . In Proceedings of the Nineteenth ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining 2026 Feb 22 (pp. 1341-1342).
TIST	Bigdeli A, Ebrahimi S , Arabzadeh N, Salamat S, SeyedSalehi S, Khodabakhsh M, Zarrinkalam F, Bagheri E. Query Performance Prediction Using Neural Query Space Proximity . ACM Transactions on Intelligent Systems and Technology.
CIKM 2025	Ebrahimi S , Sadeghian S, Ghorbanpour A, Arabzadeh N, Salamat S, Li M, Le HS, Bashari M, Bagheri E. RottenReviews: Benchmarking Review Quality with Human and LLM-Based Judgments . In Proceedings of the 34th ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management 2025 Nov 10 (pp. 5642-5649).
CIKM 2025	Chatterjee S, Wang X, Zhang S, Ebrahimi S , Ren Z, Ganguly D, Jones G, Yilmaz E, Zamani H. ProActLLM: Proactive Conversational Information Seeking with Large Language Models . In Proceedings of the 34th ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management 2025 Nov 10 (pp. 6894-6897).
CIKM 2025	Arabzadeh N, Ebrahimi S , Ghorbanpour A, Sadeghian S, Salamat S, Li M, Son Le H, Bashari M, Bagheri E. Building Trustworthy Peer Review Quality Assessment Systems . In Proceedings of the 34th ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management 2025 Nov 10 (pp. 6863-6864).
SIGIR 2025	Soleimany S, Ebrahimi S , SeyedSalehi S, Zarrinkalam F, Bagheri E. Reinforcement Learning for Effective Few-Shot Ranking . In Proceedings of the 48th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval 2025 Jul 13 (pp. 2956-2961).

ECIR 2025	Ebrahimi S[†] , Salamat S [†] , Arabzadeh N, Bashari M, Bagheri E. exHarmony: Authorship and Citations for Benchmarking the Reviewer Assignment Problem . In European Conference on Information Retrieval 2025.
MLJ	Seyedsalehi S, Salamat S, Arabzadeh N, Ebrahimi S , Zihayat M, Bagheri E. Gender disentangled representation learning in neural rankers . Machine Learning. 2025 May;114(5):1-33.
CIKM 2024	Arabzadeh N, Ebrahimi S , Salamat S, Bashari M, Bagheri E. Reviewerly: modeling the reviewer assignment task as an information retrieval problem . In Proceedings of the 33rd ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management 2024 Oct 21 (pp. 5554-5555).
ECIR 2024	Ebrahimi S , Khodabakhsh M, Arabzadeh N, Bagheri E. Estimating query performance through rich contextualized query representations . In European Conference on Information Retrieval 2024 (pp. 49-58).

Presentations and Talks

• RottenReviews: Benchmarking Review Quality with Human and LLM-Based Judgments, <i>CIKM 2025</i>	Nov 2025
• Estimating Query Performance Through Rich Contextualized Query Representations, <i>QPP++ 2025</i>	Apr 2025
• It Takes a Team to Triumph: Collaborative Expert Finding in Community QA Networks, <i>SIGIR-AP 2024</i>	Dec 2024
• Reviewerly: A High Quality Peer Reviewer Suggestion Application, <i>OpenAlex Virtual User Conference</i>	May 2024
• Intro to Neural Information Retrieval, <i>Special Topics in Information Retrieval, University of Guelph</i>	Nov 2023

Skills

Languages: Python, C, C++

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite, MySQL, Milvus

Misc: Git, Docker, Elasticsearch, Nginx, GraphQL, HTML/CSS, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Unix-based OS

Selected Projects

DetectZoo

A unified research toolkit implementing 61 methods to detect AI-generated content across 3 modalities.

FiCi

A Python package designed to identify fake (AI-generated) citations in scientific papers.

Awards and Honors

• Best Industry Day Talk Award, 19 th ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining (WSDM)	2026
• ECIR Student Support Grant to attend ECIR 2025 Conference (330 EUR)	2025
• Braithwaite Travel Grants to attend ECIR 2024/2025, ACML 2024, SIGIR-AP 2024, COLM 2025 (total ~10k CAD)	2024
• College of Engineering Deans Graduate Entrance Scholarship, UoGuelph (5,000 CAD)	2023
• Entrance Award in Recognition of Student Excellence in the College of Engineering, UoGuelph (12,000 CAD)	2023

Academic Services

• **Co-organizer:** CIKM Workshop on Proactive Conversational Information Seeking with LLMs ([ProActLLM](#)), 2025

• **Program Committee:**

• SIGIR 2025 – 2026

• CIKM 2026

• ECIR 2026

• IP&M 2026

• TOIS 2025 – 2026

• WSDM 2026

• WWW 2026

• ICTIR 2025

• COLING 2025

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Ferdowsi University of Mashhad

2019 - 2023

- Information Retrieval, Fall 2022 - Winter 2023
- Data Mining, Winter 2022
- Database, Fall 2021 - Winter 2022
- Discrete Mathematics, Winter 2020
- Object Oriented Programming, Winter 2020
- Fundamentals of Computer Programming, Fall 2019

Middle School Instructor, Andishe Iranian School

2020 - 2021

- Taught Python programming fundamentals to students in grades 7 - 10, covering basic concepts such as variables, loops, conditionals, and functions, and fostering problem-solving and logical thinking skills.

References

References will be available upon request.